BUILD YOUR KIT OVER TIME

10-page detailed checklist | A phased 72-hour preparation plan for a household of four

Start with what you already own. A ready-made kit counts only for the supplies actually inside. Do not wait to buy a commercial kit before making a family plan.

STEP 0 - TODAY, FREE

Inventory, decide, organize

Check pantry, bottled water, flashlights, medications, first aid and safe storage. Write contacts, evacuation destinations and local alert sources. Confirm who can collect children or assist relatives.

STEP 1 - FIRST PRIORITY

Cover essential 72-hour needs

Reach basic water target (24 L for four; the 48 L in the video is the Step 2 total), suitable no-cook food for all 12 person-days, essential prescriptions, lighting, radio, first aid, personal care and a portable emergency plan. Add pet essentials if relevant.

STEP 2 - BUILD THE FULLER RESERVE

Add comfort, reliability and backups

Work toward 48 L total water; improve hygiene, warm clothing, charging, spare batteries, tool coverage, and portable go-bag supplies. This can be spread across pay periods.

STEP 3 - OPTIONAL / RISK-BASED

Upgrade only where useful

Consider additional reserves, specialized water treatment, filters, tarps and other hazard-specific items. Do not buy specialist medicines or gear without understanding when they are appropriate.

MY BUDGET & PROGRESS

PHASE	BUDGET	SPENT	NEXT DATE	DONE?
Step 1 - essentials				☐
Step 2 - fuller reserve				☐
Step 3 - optional upgrades				☐

Progress rule: mark an item OK only when its target quantity is available, usable and stored.

Checklist columns: HAVE = amount already owned | NEED = amount still missing | OK = acquired/ready.

WATER & FOOD

Food + water: build the essentials first, then expand your reserve

1 WATER & SAFE STORAGE

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Safe stored water (basic 72-hour amount)	S1	24 L / 4 people			☐
Additional stored water for cooking/cleaning	S2	+24 L (48 L total)			☐
Portable bottles included in water total	S1	Small bottles			☐
Food-grade storage containers, if self-filling	S2	Enough for target			☐
Water treatment tablets, if appropriate	S2	1 pack, backup			☐
Certified portable water filter, if suitable	S3	1, optional			☐

2 FOOD & KITCHEN ESSENTIALS

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Ready-to-eat main meals for 4 people x 3 days	S1	12 person-days			☐
Canned beans / chickpeas (example)	S2	6 x ~540 mL			☐
Shelf-stable meat / fish / plant protein (example)	S2	6 cans			☐
Ready-to-eat canned meals (example)	S2	8 cans			☐
Crackers / crispbread (example)	S2	3 x ~300 g			☐
Peanut / seed butter if allergy-safe (example)	S2	1 x 1 kg			☐
Energy / granola bars (example)	S2	24 bars			☐
Nuts / trail mix if allergy-safe (example)	S2	2 x 500 g			☐
Dried fruit / dates (example)	S2	2 x 500 g			☐
Ready-to-eat cereal (example)	S2	1 x 1 kg			☐
Shelf-stable milk / alternative (example)	S2	4 x 1 L			☐
Canned fruit (example)	S3	4 cans			☐
Manual can opener	S1	1			☐
Household-specific allergy / baby / diet foods	S1	As needed			☐

Water: federal basic guidance is 2 L/person/day (24 L for four x 3 days); plan another 2 L/person/day for cooking/cleaning when feasible (48 L total).

Food basket entries are EXAMPLES, not extra mandatory purchases on top of a complete meal plan. Check labels, calories, dietary restrictions and 12 person-days. Have no-cook options.

LIGHT, POWER & WARMTH

Count the items already inside any emergency backpack before buying duplicates

1 LIGHT, COMMUNICATIONS & CHARGING

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
LED flashlights / headlamps	S1	Up to 4			☐
Extra batteries for devices	S1	Match models			☐
Battery or hand-crank AM/FM radio	S1	1			☐
Phone charging cables and suitable adapters	S1	Per device			☐
Charged USB power bank(s)	S1	1+, per devices			☐
Dedicated spare power banks	S2	Optional backup			☐
Emergency whistle	S2	1-2			☐
Battery-powered backup lights	S3	Optional			☐

2 CLOTHING, WARMTH & CARRY BAGS

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Warm blankets / insulated sleeping bags	S1	4			☐
Seasonal clothing + durable footwear	S1	4 sets			☐
Warm socks / hats / gloves	S1	4 sets			☐
Accessible go-bags or rolling bags	S1	1-4			☐
Rain ponchos or rainwear	S2	4			☐
Emergency foil blankets	S2	4, backup			☐
Hand warmers	S3	1 pack, optional			☐
Matches or a lighter, in a waterproof bag	S1	1 each			☐

Power bank capacities are examples, not government minimums. Confirm cables and keep batteries charged. Reflective foil blankets are not insulated winter sleeping bags. Keep matches dry and away from children; never leave a flame unattended.

FIRST AID - ITEM BY ITEM

Open any existing first-aid pouch and tick what it actually contains

1 FIRST-AID SUPPLIES: CHECK THE CONTENTS

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Adhesive bandages, assorted sizes	S1	20+ suggested			☐
Sterile gauze pads, assorted sizes	S1	6+ suggested			☐
Non-stick sterile wound dressings	S1	Several			☐
Roller gauze bandage	S1	1-2 rolls			☐
Medical adhesive tape	S1	1 roll			☐
Triangular bandage	S1	1			☐
Antiseptic wipes / approved wound cleanser	S1	6+ wipes			☐
Disposable non-latex gloves	S1	4+ pairs			☐
Bandage scissors	S1	1			☐
Tweezers	S1	1			☐
Digital thermometer	S1	1			☐
First-aid instructions	S1	1 booklet			☐
First-aid pouch / case	S1	1			☐
Elastic support bandage	S2	1			☐
Large absorbent wound dressing	S2	1-2			☐
Safety pins / bandage clips	S2	A few			☐
Sterile wound-rinsing saline	S2	1 bottle			☐
Instant cold pack	S2	1-2			☐
CPR face shield / barrier	S2	1			☐
Eye dressing / eye pads	S2	1-2			☐

Suggested quantities are illustrative, not a certification standard. Keep emergency numbers and basic first-aid instructions accessible. Replace expired or used supplies.

MEDICINES & HYGIENE

Select medicines and medical equipment for your actual household needs

1 MEDICINES, MEDICAL NEEDS & SPECIAL DIETS

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Regular prescriptions	S1	3+ days if allowed			☐
Written medications / doses / instructions	S1	1 list			☐
Inhalers / epinephrine / diabetes supplies	S1	If prescribed			☐
Medical devices + backup power (tell your utility)	S1	As needed			☐
Spare glasses / contact lenses / supplies	S1	As needed			☐
Age-appropriate pain / fever medicine	S2	If appropriate			☐
Allergy medicine	S2	If appropriate			☐
Hearing aid batteries / aids	S1	If needed			☐
Infant formula / feeding equipment	S1	If needed			☐

2 TOILETRIES, CLEANUP & PERSONAL SUPPLIES

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Toilet paper	S1	1 multipack			☐
Soap or handwash	S1	1+			☐
Toothbrushes and toothpaste	S1	4 + 1			☐
Hand sanitizer	S1	~500 mL			☐
Heavy-duty garbage bags	S1	1 roll			☐
Waterproof resealable bags	S1	1 box			☐
Menstrual, diaper or incontinence supplies	S1	As needed			☐
Wet wipes	S2	2 packs			☐
Tissues and paper towels	S2	1 pack each			☐
Shampoo and other hygiene supplies	S2	As needed			☐
Disposable cleanup gloves	S2	1 small pack			☐
Well-fitting protective masks, if appropriate	S3	By risk/fit			☐

Do not start or stockpile medicines without appropriate guidance. Age-appropriate medication, allergies, medical devices and pet needs take priority over optional equipment.

TOOLS, DOCUMENTS & HOME SAFETY

Use the packing page to organize these same supplies; do not count them twice

1 HOME SAFETY & PRACTICAL TOOLS

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Working smoke and carbon-monoxide alarms	S1	As required			☐
Duct tape	S2	1 roll			☐
Multi-tool or pocket tool	S2	1			☐
Flat + Phillips screwdrivers	S2	1 each			☐
Pliers + adjustable wrench	S2	1 each			☐
Work gloves	S2	1 pair			☐
Utility knife with protective sheath	S3	1, optional			☐
Weatherproof tarp / emergency shelter	S3	1, optional			☐
Utility rope	S3	As needed			☐
Outdoor-only cooking stove / fuel	S3	Only if safe & needed			☐

2 DOCUMENTS, CONTACTS & CASH

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Printed emergency contacts / household plan	S1	1 set			☐
Copies of identity, health, insurance records	S1	1 protected set			☐
Medicine / medical provider contact list	S1	1 copy			☐
Small-bill cash	S1	Household amount			☐
Spare home / car keys	S1	1 set			☐
Local paper map	S2	1			☐
Pen and notepad	S2	1 each			☐
Children's small comfort activity	S2	As needed			☐
Waterproof document pouch	S1	1			☐

Never use camp stoves, barbecues or fuel-powered generators indoors, in garages or tents. Use working carbon monoxide alarms and follow local emergency instructions.

PETS - SUPPLIES & TRANSPORT

Use this page only if your household includes animals

1 FOOD, TRANSPORT & ROUTINE CARE

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Regular pet food (do not change abruptly)	S1	3+ days / pet			☐
Pet water, separate from family water	S1	Dog ~12 L / cat ~3 L*			☐
Food and drinking bowls	S1	2 / pet			☐
Prescribed pet medications	S1	3+ days, if needed			☐
Vet and 24-hour clinic contact numbers	S1	1 copy			☐
Vaccination/medical and ownership records	S1	1 set / pet			☐
Recent photo + current ID/microchip info	S1	Per pet			☐
Written feeding / medicine instructions	S1	1 / pet			☐
Secure transport carrier or crate	S1	As appropriate			☐
Secure dog leash + correctly fitted harness	S1	1 set / dog			☐
Dog waste bags	S1	1 roll			☐
Cat carrier (one per cat)	S1	1 / cat			☐
Cat litter, portable litter pan and scoop	S1	3+ days / cat			☐
Cat / dog transport absorbent pads	S2	Small pack			☐
Portable pet go-bag / tote	S1	1 per pet			☐
Familiar pet towel / blanket / toy	S2	1 each / pet			☐
Pet-safe cleaner / paper towels	S2	Small supply			☐
Breakaway cat ID collar, if appropriate	S3	1 / cat			☐
Spare leash / collar for dog	S2	1			☐

*Federal example water amounts: about 4 L/day per average dog and 1 L/day per average cat. Adjust for each pet, especially in hot weather or for special medical needs.

PET FIRST AID & EVACUATION

Complete these sections only if pets are part of your household

PET FIRST AID - CHECK EACH SUPPLY

ITEM / SUPPLY	STEP	TARGET	HAVE	NEED	OK
Sterile gauze / non-stick dressings	S1	1 small set			☐
Roller bandage + medical tape	S1	1 each			☐
Disposable non-latex gloves	S1	2+ pairs			☐
Clean pet towel / washcloth	S1	1			☐
Pet emergency + poison contacts	S1	Written list			☐
Bandage scissors and tweezers	S2	1 each			☐
Sterile saline wound rinse	S2	1			☐
Vet-approved first-aid additions	S2	If advised			☐
Pet thermometer	S3	If vet recommends			☐

PET EVACUATION - PREPARATION TASKS (NOT EXTRA PURCHASES)

- ☐ Check carrier size and secure transport for every pet
- ☐ Pack pet food, water, bowls, medication and cleaning supplies
- ☐ Put pet identification, recent photos and records into the go-bag
- ☐ Write down veterinarian, emergency clinic and pet-friendly contacts
- ☐ Identify a pet-friendly evacuation destination and a backup
- ☐ Practice safe loading of carriers and secure transportation

Never give human medicines to pets unless a veterinarian advises it. Pet first-aid contents are suggestions, not a substitute for professional veterinary care.

PACK THE GO-BAGS & TEST THE PLAN

These are packing and planning tasks, NOT another set of purchases

Home storage holds the bulk of food and water. Go-bags contain portable essentials and assume you have a safe destination. Do not try to carry your full household water reserve.

GO-BAG PACKING - TICK WHEN PHYSICALLY PACKED

- [ ] Pack portable water and suitable ready-to-eat snacks
- [ ] Pack necessary medicines and a current medication list
- [ ] Pack flashlight, radio access, batteries, phone cable/power
- [ ] Pack a compact first-aid selection and hygiene items
- [ ] Pack cash, keys and protected copies of essential documents
- [ ] Pack seasonal clothing, warm layer and suitable shoes
- [ ] Pack child comfort item and any specialized supplies
- [ ] For pets, pack carrier/leash, food, water, meds, ID records

FAMILY PREPARATION - TICK WHEN COMPLETED

- [ ] Choose a meeting place close to home and a backup outside the area
- [ ] Choose an out-of-area contact and write their phone number
- [ ] Set school / childcare pickup or reunification arrangements
- [ ] Know where to get official alerts without internet access
- [ ] Choose evacuation destination and alternate travel plan
- [ ] Identify helpers for people with mobility or medical needs
- [ ] Test radio, charge devices and locate the entire kit
- [ ] Review expiry dates and refresh supplies at least twice a year

Not ready? Return to the item inventory pages and record the missing quantity.

HOUSEHOLD PLAN & MAINTENANCE

Fill this in, print it, and keep it with your kit or on the fridge. Update it when anything changes.

1 CONTACTS & IMPORTANT NUMBERS

OUR EMERGENCY NUMBER	POISON CONTROL	POLICE / FIRE NON-EMERGENCY
OUT-OF-AREA CONTACT	THEIR NUMBER / HOW TO REACH THEM	DOCTOR / PHARMACY
INSURANCE: COMPANY + POLICY NO.	INSURANCE CLAIMS PHONE	POWER / WATER OUTAGE LINE
BUILDING / LANDLORD CONTACT	SCHOOL / CHILDCARE	BACKUP CAREGIVER
VET / PET EMERGENCY CLINIC	WHERE WE GET OFFICIAL ALERTS	OTHER IMPORTANT NUMBER

2 OUR PLAN

PEOPLE IN OUR HOME (AND PETS)	OUR LOCAL RISKS (FLOOD, STORM…)	OTHER SPECIAL NEEDS
NEAR-HOME MEETING PLACE	BACKUP MEETING PLACE	EVACUATION DESTINATION
ALTERNATE DESTINATION	KIT STORAGE LOCATION	WATER STORED / LITRES
PRESCRIPTIONS + FIRST-AID LOCATION	LAST SUPPLY CHECK	NEXT SUPPLY CHECK

REVIEW & SAFE USE

- Use this as a planning tool; it cannot guarantee safety in every emergency. Follow official warnings and evacuation instructions.
- For home-filled water, use safe food-grade containers, label dates and replace stored water every 6 months.
- Basic filters and purification tablets may not remove viruses or chemicals; follow official water safety advisories.
- Specialized items, including KI tablets, are not universal essentials. Take KI only when authorities direct you.

PUBLIC GUIDANCE USED FOR THIS INDEPENDENT WORKSHEET

Canada - Emergency kit checklist canada.ca/en/services/policing/emergencies/preparedness/get-prepared/emergency-kits/get-kit.html
Health Canada - Food and drinking water safety in an emergency canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/food-drinking-water-safe-emergency.html
Canadian Red Cross - First aid kit contents redcross.ca/training-and-certification/first-aid-tips-and-resources/first-aid-tips/wellness-and-injury-prevention/kit-contents
Canada - Pets and service animals canada.ca/en/services/policing/emergencies/preparedness/get-prepared/emergency-planning-resources/animals.html
Canada - Carbon monoxide safety canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/air-quality/pollutants/carbon-monoxide/preventing-exposure.html
UK - Be Ready beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/
CDC - Safe emergency water storage cdc.gov/water-emergency/about/how-to-create-and-store-an-emergency-water-supply.html